



Incident Report Writing

Student Leader Education and Development

Friday, August 15th

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What is an IR?

As a Student Leader, an important part of your position will be to respond to various situations in your community. These situations might include an intoxicated student, a students with a mental health concern, a noisy room, etc...

It is your responsibility to respond to these situations and document everything. This includes things you see, hear and smell. The information that you document and submit to your CD/GSA is called an Incident Report (IR).



When do I submit an IR?

- You will submit a report for all policy violations or concerns.
- Any time Public Safety is in the building.
- Your CD/GSA needs to be aware of any details that helps contribute to our overall picture of a student's experience
- The incident reports you submit are extremely important to the CD/GSA as this information is used through follow-up conversations and conduct meetings.



Advocate, what is it?

Advocate is an online system the university (primarily Residence Life and Dean of Students) uses to address, track, and process behavioral concerns among students. There are two forms in Advocate you will use in your role as an RA:

- **Code of Conduct:** When you are made aware of some violation of policy, you must submit an incident report. This can include but is not limited to: vandalism, substance concerns, and physical violence.
- **General Concern/FYI:** When a student is in distress, or you have information about a student in crisis, you should submit a General Concern/FYI in order to communicate it.



Title IX Reporting

- In your role, you may encounter incidents where you become aware of Title IX related concerns.
- Title IX related concerns are highly confidential and should not be reported through Roomcompact or Advocate. Rather, utilize the university's [Title IX Reporting Form](#).



How to Write a Quality IR

When you submit an Incident Report (IR), it becomes part of a formal, written record for the Office of Residence Life, the Dean of Students Office and the University as a whole. It can be requested for review by University staff as well as the student and their representatives. Therefore, please be sure to consider the following:

- Do not include your opinions about a resident or their behavior. Report just the facts.
 - Example - Opinion: The resident was non-compliant.
 - Example - Facts/Observations: Resident [Last Name] raised their voice with Public Safety Officers and repeatedly refused to sit down after multiple directives.



How to Write a Quality IR (cont.)

- Include all relevant facts about the incident - how you became aware of the situation, information about all involved parties, facts about the violation or situation. Be as objective and thorough as possible, and start off every incident report with the date/time. The IR should read as a moment-by-moment description of what occurred.
- When possible, use exact quotes from residents involved (especially when they are yelling, swearing, etc.).



How to Write a Quality IR (cont.)

- If you realize you left something out after submitting the IR, misidentified someone or included anything else that needs to be corrected, let your CD/GSA know as soon as possible. If you can't confirm what you wrote - don't write it! Write the IR considering others will read it. Proof read for content as well as accuracy.
- Check spelling, grammar, and sentence structure - the basics you would correct on a paper. It is best to type the report in a word document first and copy/paste the narrative into Advocate.

How to Write a Quality IR (cont.)

- When Public Safety is involved, take down the last name of all officers involved and the report number. If you miss some information, you should ask the PS officers to fill in those missing details.
- **You should submit this report as soon as possible and definitely before you go to bed for the night. Do not wait until morning to submit it.**
- If you have notes with ID numbers and other sensitive information, give them to your CD/GSA and they will shred that information
- You will be submitting your incident reports on a website called Advocate. The link can be found [here](#).



Resident Advisor Jisoo Kim received a call from Rose Park. Rose reported that they smelt weed on the 8th floor new FRH 8816. RA Kim then contacted public safety to report the odor of weed. RA Kim met Pub Safe on 8th floor Flynn and did a walk through of the floor. Pub safe and RA Kim did not detect the strong odor she had described. Pub safe and RA Kim proceeded to the 9th Floor to see if the odor could be detected on that floor. RA Kim and Pub safe could not smell the odor on the 9th floor.



Resident Advisor Jisoo Kim received a call from **Rose Park**. **Rose** reported that they **smelt weed** on the 8th floor new FRH 8816. RA Kim then contacted public safety to report the odor of **weed**. RA Kim met **Pub Safe** on 8th floor Flynn and did a walk through of the floor. **Pub safe** and RA Kim did not detect the strong odor **she** had described. **Pub safe** and RA Kim proceeded to the 9th Floor to see if the odor could be detected on that floor. RA Kim and **Pub safe** could not smell the odor on the 9th floor.



Good IR



On Friday October 33rd, 2025 at 9:10pm Resident Advisor Jisoo Kim received a call from FRH 8816 Resident Rose Park. Resident Park reported that there was a strong smell of marijuana on the 8th floor new FRH 8816. RA Kim then contacted public safety to report the odor of marijuana at 9:15pm. RA Kim met Public Safety officer Swift on 8th floor Flynn and did a walk through of the floor. Officer Swift and RA Kim did not detect the strong odor Resident Park had described. Officer Swift and RA Kim proceeded to the 9th Floor to see if the odor could be detected on that floor. RA Kim and Officer Swift could not smell the odor on the 9th floor. Officer Swift directed RA Kim to make contact with Resident Park and direct that if Resident Park smells marijuana again they should reach out to the RA on duty again. RA Kim spoke with Resident Park at 9:30pm and the incident concluded at 9:32pm.

Bad IR



RA Kim heard loud music and screaming coming from the north end of the 3rd floor of Dowling hall. RA Kim proceeded towards those rooms and found Resident Jeongyeon Yoo holding open the door a room door. She was holding an open can of Loon Juice Hard Cider and was wooing at the unidentified persons inside the room. RA Kim contacted Public Safety due to the presence of alcohol. Two unidentified individuals exited DOW 13, and walked toward the elevator. Pub Safe arrived and knocked on the door of DOW 13. She opened the door and asked why public safety was at their door.. Officer Smith asked her if she had consumed any alcohol this evening. There was Loon Juice Hard Cider were on the desk. She was clearly drunk and Officer Smith asked her to sit down. Resident Yoo sat down and stated yes they had consumed alcohol. Officer Smith then performed a PBT on her. DOW 13 Resident Chaeyoung Son returned to the room. Officer Smith determined that as long as she would be in the room to assist her that she could remain in the room. She agreed to keep an eye on her. Pub Sage advised her that they should expect to be contacted by the Dean of Student Office about the conduct process and Pub Sage confiscated the remaining cans of unopened Loon Juice Hard cider and with Jennie Kim proceeded to the bathroom to dump out the alcohol.

Bad IR



RA Kim heard loud music and screaming coming from the north end of the 3rd floor of Dowling hall. RA Kim proceeded towards those rooms and found Resident Jeongyeon Yoo holding open the door a room door. She was holding an open can of Loon Juice Hard Cider and was wooing at the unidentified persons inside the room. RA Kim contacted Public Safety due to the presence of alcohol. Two unidentified individuals exited DOW 13, and walked toward the elevator. Pub Safe arrived and knocked on the door of DOW 13. She opened the door and asked why public safety was at their door.. Officer Smith asked her if she had consumed any alcohol this evening. There was Loon Juice Hard Cider were on the desk. She was clearly drunk and Officer Smith asked her to sit down. Resident Yoo sat down and stated yes they had consumed alcohol. Officer Smith then performed a PBT on her. DOW 13 Resident Chaeyoung Son returned to the room. Officer Smith determined that as long as she would be in the room to assist her that she could remain in the room. She agreed to keep an eye on her. Pub Sage advised her that they should expect to be contacted by the Dean of Student Office about the conduct process and Pub Sage confiscated the remaining cans of unopened Loon Juice Hard cider and with Jennie Kim proceeded to the bathroom to dump out the alcohol.

Good IR

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On Tuesday March 32nd at 12am Resident Advisor Jennie Kim was on rounds when RA Kim heard loud music and screaming coming from the north end of the 3rd floor of Dowling hall. RA Kim proceeded towards those rooms and found Resident Jeongyeon Yoo holding open the door of DOW 13. Resident Yoo was holding an open can of Loon Juice Hard Cider and was wooing at the unidentified persons inside the room. RA Kim asked Resident Yoo to step back inside DOW 13 and close the door, Resident Yoo followed that instruction. At 12:06am RA Kim contacted Public Safety due to the presence of alcohol. At 12:08am two unidentified individuals exited DOW 13, and walked toward the elevator. RA Kim asked them to wait but they continued to the elevator. Public Safety officer Smith arrived at 12:15am and knocked on the door of DOW 13. Resident Yoo opened the door and asked why public safety was at their door. Resident Yoo is the only occupant of the DOW 13. Officer Smith asked Resident Yoo if they had consumed any alcohol this evening. Six cans of Loon Juice Hard Cider were present on a desk in the room. Resident Yoo was wobbling slightly and Officer Smith asked Resident Yoo to sit down. Resident Yoo sat down and stated yes they had consumed alcohol. Officer Smith then performed a PBT on Resident Yoo and the test came back with a .09. At 12:25am DOW 13 Resident Chaeyoung Son returned to the room. Resident Son had not consumed any alcohol in the evening and was not present for the alcohol consumption in DOW 13. Officer Smith determined that as long as Resident Son would be in the room to assist Resident Yoo that Resident Yoo could remain in the room and would not have to be taken to the Care Room. Resident Son agreed to keep an eye on Resident Yoo. Officer Smith advised Resident Yoo that they should expect to be contacted by the Dean of Student Office about the conduct process and Officer Smith confiscated the remaining three cans of unopened Loon Juice Hard cider and with RA Kim proceeded to the bathroom to dump out the alcohol. Incident concluded at 12:35am



Common IR Writing Mistakes:

Correct:	Incorrect:
Smelled	Smelt
Public Safety	Pub Safe
Marijuana or THC	Weed
Residents/Students	Residence
Intoxicated	Drunk
Residence Hall	Dorm
Description of actions	Summary/judgement of actions

Your Practice!

- On Canvas, we have organized an IR writing module for you.
- You will write a practice IR based on a linked video
- Your supervisor will review your IR writing and give feedback

